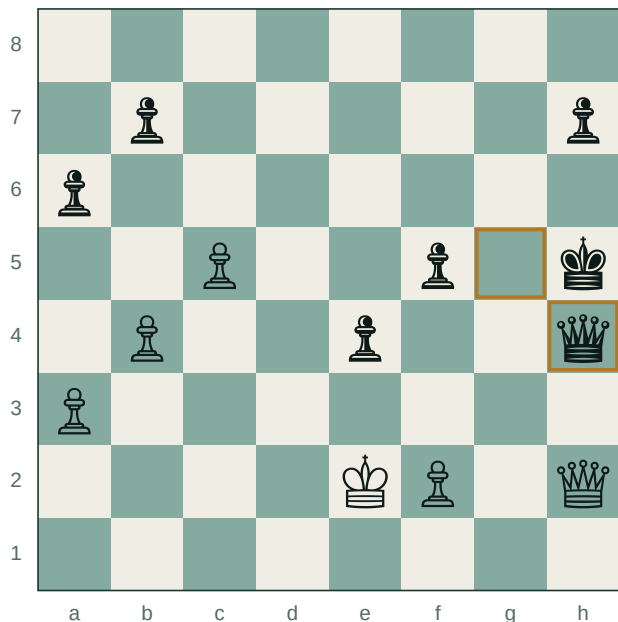


Queen-ending tactics: White, move 51

Queen-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 50...Qh4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

51. Qxh4+ Kxh4 52. a4 Kg5 53. b5

51.Qxh4+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on h4. Recorded reply: **51...Kxh4**.

52.a4 The pawn moves from a3 to a4. Recorded reply: **52...Kg5**.

53.b5 The pawn moves from b4 to b5.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on h5. Absolute pin: queen on h4.